Ensemble Series

UCF Percussion Ensemble

Thad Anderson, director

featuring Gordon Stout & Heather Thorn, guest artists

March 7, 2024
7:00 PM
Rehearsal Hall Auditorium

—Program—

New York Triptych — Gordon Stout
Michael Colbassani, Ethan Nasypany, Sam Matter, & Christian Snedeker

Elegy for Ukraine — Gordon Stout
featuring guest artist Gordon Stout

Look Forward with Your Feet — Gordon Stout
featuring Sam Matter
Joseph Cassidy, Ashley Gilbert, Skylar Pearson, Logan Ruch, & Caleb Schmaus

Bluebird Samba — Theodore Rounds
Zane Adams, Evan Carville, Logan Newhouse, & Grace Singh

—Intermission—

A retrospective of the 1976 Eastman Marimba Band album *Nola*

Cross Corners — G.H. Green, arr. Becker
Michael Colbassani, soloist
Zack Hoening, Ethan Nasypany, Christian Snedeker, & Nathaniel Woodall

Powder Puff — Harry Breuer, arr. Moore
Ethan Nasypany, soloist
Michael Colbassani, Zack Hoening, Christian Snedeker, & Nathaniel Woodall

Rainbow Ripples — G.H. Green, arr. Mancini
Joseph Cassidy, soloist
Thad Anderson, Skylar Pearson, & Logan Ruch

Dance of the Octopus — Red Norvo, arr. Stout
Skylar Pearson, soloist
Thad Anderson, Joseph Cassidy, & Logan Ruch

Steinway is the official piano of the UCF Music Department
Turn off all cell phones. No flash photography.

Log Cabin Blues — G.H. Green, arr. Mancini

Ashley Gilbert, soloist
Emmaline Kealoha, Sam Matter, & Caleb Schmaus

On the Woodpile — Harry Breuer, arr. Stout

Emmaline Kealoha, soloist
Ashley Gilbert, Sam Matter, & Caleb Schmaus

Nola — Felix Arndt, arr. Green & Mancini

Zane Adams, soloist
Evan Carville, Logan Newhouse, & Grace Singh

The Whistler — G.H. Green, arr. Mancini

Evan Carville, soloist
Zane Adams, Logan Newhouse, & Grace Singh

Back Talk — Harry Breuer, arr. Stout

Heather Thorn, guest artist soloist
Thad Anderson, Jeff Moore, & Gordon Stout

Chromatic Fox-Trot — G.H. Green, arr. Becker

Heather Thorn, guest artist soloist
Thad Anderson, Jeff Moore, Logan Newhouse, & Gordon Stout

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—About the Artists—

Gordon Stout (b.1952) is Professor Emeritus at the School of Music, Ithaca College, Ithaca, N.Y., where he taught from 1980 through 2019. A composer as well as percussionist who specializes on marimba, he has studied composition with Joseph Schwantner, Samuel Adler and Warren Benson, and percussion with James Salmon and John Beck.

Many of his compositions for marimba are published and have already become standard repertoire for marimbists world-wide. A frequent lecture-recitalist for the Percussive Arts Society, he has appeared at more than a dozen International PAS Conventions to date as featured marimbist, as well as throughout the United States and Canada, Europe, Japan, Taiwan, Thailand, Singapore, Hungary, Bulgaria, Mexico, Denmark, Puerto Rico, Italy, Greece, and Spain.. In May of 1983 he performed clinics and recitals in France, Germany, Holland, and Belgium with "transcendental virtuosity" being described as "the Rubinstein of all aspects of the marimba".

Gordon has been on the Jury of seven different international marimba competitions. On new year's day in 2006 he conducted a 100-person marimba orchestra in the National Concert Hall in Taipei, Taiwan as part of the Taiwan International Percussion Convention. His composition "New York Triptych" for marimba orchestra, was commissioned by and written for the 50th anniversary celebration of the Percussive Arts Society, premiered at PASIC 2011 in Indianapolis, IN. He has also conducted marimba orchestras in Australia, Croatia, and throughout the United States. Most recently he conducted a marimba orchestra of 75 persons on 120 marimbas at Kutztown University in PA in November of 2015.

Gordon was inducted into the Percussive Arts Society Hall of Fame in November of 2012. In 2019 his newest venture was launched: G&C Music, which will be the new home of Full Circle Publications and StoutWorks. Gordon Stout owns and plays a 5.0 marimba made by Coe Percussion. It features a Deagan inspired tubular frame with Composition Resonators. For more information go to www.coepercussion.com.

Heather Thorn is a xylophonist in Orlando, FL where she performs with her band Vivacity and as a freelance percussionist. She holds a degree in Music Performance with a minor in Theatre from Ithaca College. In 2019 and 2022, she was featured with Vivacity as the headline act for the I Love Jazz International Jazz Festival in Brazil. She was also a guest soloist with the Orlando Philharmonic Orchestra in 2021 for the Holiday Pops concert. Heather has been featured as a guest artist with Michael Andrew and Swingerhead, The Dirty River Jazz Band in San Antonio and as an opening act for the Glenn Miller Orchestra. As band leader of Vivacity, she frequently performs for swing dances and at renowned Central Florida venues including Timucua Arts White House and the Blue Bamboo Center for the Arts; in 2018 she gave a concert at the New Orleans Jazz Museum. Heather wrote and performs her musical stage show Nostalgia Radio Hour- featuring an original script with classic tunes from the 1920's- 1950's, and characters inspired from the Golden Age of Radio. She also leads a jazz quartet at the Sea World Christmas Celebration and subs with the Walt Disney World Orchestra. Heather has performed for the Suncoast Jazz Festival and New Smyrna Beach Jazz Festival as well as several arts festivals and community events all over Central Florida. She regularly features jazz luminaries such as Adrian Cunningham, Ed Metz, and Charlie Bertini as guests with the band. Heather has a private teaching studio of 30 students and is a clinician in several schools along with co-directing the Trinity Prep School percussion program. Additionally, she has given master classes and/or performed at Virginia Tech, Texas Lutheran University and the universities of South, Central and North Florida, and was a keynote speaker for the Tao Beta Sigma National Convention in 2023.

Heather has a passionate interest in the history of xylophone and is worked with Bill Cahn of NEXUS on a project to digitize and preserve nearly 1500 recordings of xylophone and percussion music from 1898-1929. She has attended the Leigh Howard Stevens Marimba Seminar and was on faculty for the Bob Becker Ragtime Institute in 2014. Her teachers have included Gordon Stout and Bob Becker. Heather proudly endorses Malletech Instruments.